

Physical Education

Year 8

Cambridge Lower Secondary
Student Manual



PRIME BOOKS

Physical Education

Year 8 · Student Book · Lower Secondary

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Editorial Board

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This publication reflects a shared commitment to academic quality, professional integrity and the continuous advancement of teaching and learning. We thank the Pedagogical Department and the Content Creation Team of Prime School for their work on this book.

YEAR 8 • 2026–2027

Welcome

This book is your Year 8 Physical Education course. It is written for Lower Secondary students who already have Year 7 foundations and are ready for systems, race plans and more honest match play.

Across three terms you will study six sports. Each unit starts with rules and safety, then builds techniques, then asks you to use those techniques in games. Fitness, cooperation and fair play run through every page. The aim is not only to win the lesson. It is to leave Year 8 able to join a game, look after yourself and help a teammate.



A Year 8 sports hall holds more than one sport. The habit that travels is how you arrive, listen and try the next skill.

Term 1 • Volleyball

Term 1 • Cross Country

Term 2 • Tennis

Term 2 • Athletics

Term 3 • Rugby

Term 3 • Sports Aerobics

What this year is for

By the end of the course you should be able to:

- ✓ Perform more advanced sport-specific movement skills with control.
- ✓ Improve fitness: strength, endurance, flexibility, speed, agility, balance, coordination and power.
- ✓ Apply tactics in individual and team sports.
- ✓ Communicate, lead and cooperate under the pressure of a game.
- ✓ Show respect, discipline and fair play.
- ✓ Reflect on performance and name a precise next step.
- ✓ Build habits that support a lifetime of physical activity.

How each unit is built

1 INTRODUCTION

History, rules, equipment, safety and the point of the sport.

2 SKILL

Techniques taught in order, with a clear picture of what good looks like.

3 PRACTICE

Individual, pair and team drills that raise the number of good repetitions.

4 GAME

Scenarios with one constraint, then more open match play.

5 ASSESSMENT

Skills shown in authentic play, plus fitness or written evidence when needed.

6 REFLECTION

Cool-down, then one keep and one change.

How to use this book

Start every unit by reading the introduction. Understand the rules and the first techniques before you chase speed. Each topic page follows the same furniture so you can find your way in a busy sports hall.

Feature	What it is for
Introduction	Rules, equipment and the point of the sport.
Skill focus	The technique, written so you can rehearse it.
Coach's tip	One piece of advice that usually changes the next attempt.
Watch out	The common mistake, named before you make it.
Try this	Drills and tasks. Do them. Do not only read them.
Game scenarios	The skill inside a real decision.
Check	Short questions to talk through with a partner or your teacher.

COACH'S TIP

Begin each unit with the introduction. Understanding the rules, objectives and first techniques will help you learn the sport with confidence.

HOW TO STUDY A UNIT

1. Read the introduction and walk the court, course or sector.
2. Watch the demonstration, then try the skill slowly.
3. Complete the drills with a partner who tells you the truth.
4. Use the skill in the game scenario.
5. Write one precise reflection.

Three terms

Term	Sports	What develops
1	Volleyball and Cross Country	Net systems, talk, endurance, pacing and outdoor judgement.
2	Tennis and Athletics	Racket skills, footwork, sprinting, jumping, throwing and personal bests.
3	Rugby and Sports Aerobics	Support play, defensive lines, rhythm, strength, flexibility and performance.

Learner habits

CONFIDENT

Try the weaker side and the new role.

RESPONSIBLE

Look after people, kit and the rules.

REFLECTIVE

Name what changed after feedback.

INNOVATIVE

Solve the next picture of the game, not the last one.

ENGAGED

Arrive ready, stay in the task, help the group finish well.

FAIR

Tell the truth about the line, the foul and the effort.



Fitness work in this book is a way to measure your own change, not a way to rank your friends.

Safety and kit

Physical Education is safer when the rules are boring and everyone keeps them. Year 8 sports add nets, runways, throwing sectors and contact-free rugby. The habits below apply to every unit.

Habit	Why it matters
Jewellery off, hair tied, laces double-knotted	Fingers, eyes and ankles are hard to replace.
The right shoe for the surface	Studs on a hard court and socks on a polished studio are both mistakes.
Water before you are thirsty	Outdoor running and indoor jumping both dry you out.
Tell the teacher if you are hurt	Playing on is not bravery when the next person inherits the injury.
Stop the game when someone is down	The score can wait.

WATCH OUT

A throwing sector, a long-jump pit and a rugby grid all look empty until someone walks into them. Look before you collect, rake or chase.

COACH'S TIP

If you are not sure whether the space is live, treat it as live.

Keeping score and keeping peace

Year 8 students are expected to run parts of their own games. That is a skill. A good official is loud enough, still enough and honest enough that the next point can start.

VOLLEYBALL

Say the score before the serve. Call the rotation.
Replay if you are genuinely unsure.

TENNIS

The receiver's call on a line is accepted. The server says the score.

ATHLETICS

A foul is a fact. Measure the legal mark. Do not negotiate the tape.

RUGBY

Show the touch count. A two-handed touch is the whole decision.

TRY THIS ALL YEAR

- Volunteer to score one game per unit.
- Practise the voice: score first, then the restart.
- If two people disagree, replay. The lesson is longer than the argument.

How you are assessed

Assessment gives you more than one way to show what you can do: practical performance, fitness, and written knowledge if practical evidence is missing. It follows the aims of a Lower Secondary Physical Education course: skill, teamwork, responsibility, reflection and a habit of staying active.

Type	What it looks at	When
Collective sports	Skills, tactics, talk, fair play in a team game.	End of a half-term or term
Physical fitness	Strength, endurance and change over time.	Across the year
Written knowledge	Rules, techniques, tactics, safety and terms.	When practical evidence is incomplete

Collective sports assessment

At the end of a team unit you will play. Isolated drills may support the picture, but the game is the main evidence. Teachers watch whether you can:

- Show the techniques of the sport under pressure.
- Make useful decisions.
- Communicate and cooperate.
- Respect rules, officials, teammates and opponents.

Fitness tests

Fitness scores are personal. The question is whether you improved, not whether you beat the person next to you.

Test	Component
Press-up test	Upper-body strength and endurance
Sit-up test	Core strength and endurance
20 m shuttle run (beep test)	Aerobic endurance

If you miss practical lessons

Regular attendance is part of the subject. If there is not enough practical evidence, you will sit a written paper on the sports of that term: rules, techniques, tactics, safety, equipment and terms. It is marked out of 100 per cent and contributes to the year.

What teachers record

- Observations in lessons and matches.
- Fitness tests.
- Your own reflections.
- Written work when it is needed.

ASSESSMENT PHILOSOPHY

Assessment is designed to measure performance and to encourage growth, resilience, teamwork and a lifelong habit of physical activity. Every student is given more than one way to show what they know and what they can do.

Your fitness record

Write the date and the number. Compare yourself with September, not with the loudest person in the room.

Test	Term 1	Term 2	Term 3
Press-ups (in 60 s, or to form)			
Sit-ups (in 60 s, or to form)			
20 m shuttle (level reached)			
How I felt that day			

ONE SENTENCE AFTER EACH TEST

Write what changed: sleep, a cold, a better pace, a worse start. The sentence is part of the record.

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UNIT 1 • TERM 1

Volleyball

A net game of three contacts and constant talk. Year 8 adds systems: a designated setter, a receive shape and a block that has a job.

UNIT 1

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain volleyball history, scoring, rotation and the three-contact rule.
- ✓ Identify court markings, antennae, positions and serving order.
- ✓ Perform forearm pass, set, underhand and overhand serve, spike and block.
- ✓ Use a simple offence and a compact defence in 6 v 6.
- ✓ Talk every ball and play fairly.
- ✓ Reflect after a match and name one team improvement.



Volleyball is a series of short problems. Pass, set, attack. Then recover your base before the next ball.

Topics in this unit

1.1 Introduction and rules

1.2 Warm-ups

1.3 Ball control

1.4 Attacking skills

1.5 Defensive skills

1.6 Game strategies

1.7 Game scenarios

1.8 Cool-down and reflection

1.9 Collective assessment

Fitness this unit develops

- Agility
- Coordination
- Speed
- Balance
- Power
- Reaction time

Sporting values

- Call the ball early: mine, yours, help.
- Celebrate a good pass, not only a winning spike.
- Rotate without argument.
- Help retrieve balls so the next rally can start.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

1.1 Introduction and rules

Volleyball was invented in 1895 by William G. Morgan in Massachusetts as a less rough indoor game than basketball. FIVB now governs the international sport. A school match is six players a side. A team may play the ball three times before it must cross the net. A block contact does not count as one of those three in the full game.

Rally scoring is used: every rally wins a point. A set is usually first to 25, win by two. You rotate clockwise when you win the right to serve. Year 8 volleyball is not Year 7 passing with a louder shout. It is a system: someone receives, someone sets, someone attacks.

The court is 18 m by 9 m. The attack line sits 3 m from the centre line. Antennae mark the crossing space. Trainers, a raised net and a ball that is not soaked are the kit. Jewellery off. Nails short.



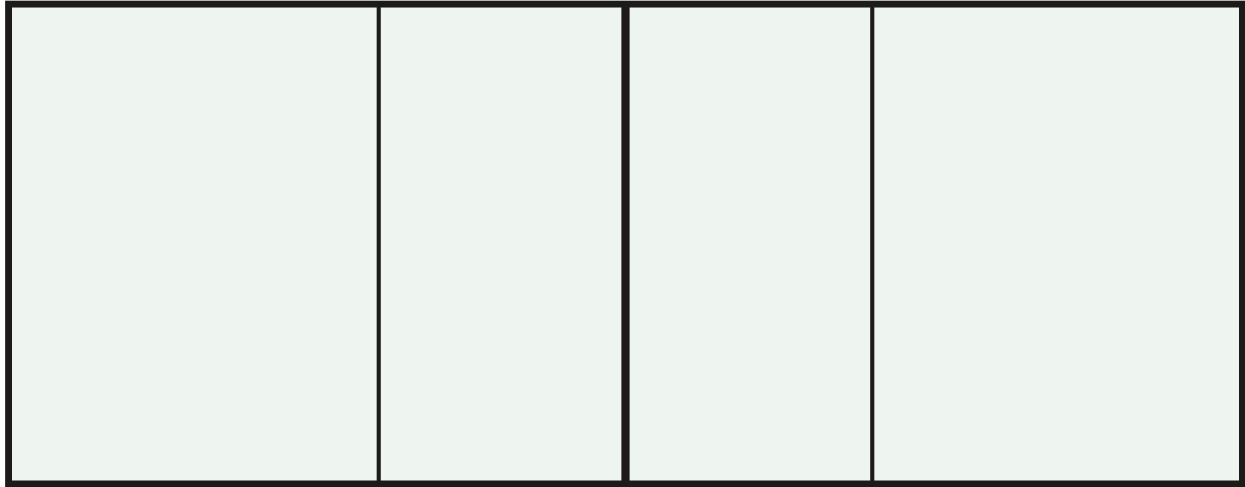
Net, antennae and the attack line: the three marks you must be able to name before the first serve.

KEY POINTS

- Six players, three contacts, then over.
- Rally scoring: every rally is a point.
- Rotate when you win the serve.
- Antennae, attack line and serving order are not optional decorations.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Volleyball: centre line and attack lines (3 m from the net)

**Try this**

1. Walk the court and name baseline, sideline, attack line, centre line and antenna.
2. Write the serving order for a starting six.
3. List three ways Year 8 volleyball is different from a park knockabout.

WATCH OUT

Serving before the rotation is set is how easy points are given away.

COACH'S TIP

Learn the three-contact habit before you chase a spectacular spike.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What does rally scoring mean?
2. When does a team rotate?
3. Why does a block contact matter in the counting of touches?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

1.2 Warm-ups

A volleyball warm-up wakes the shoulders, ankles and the small steps you will use under the ball. Jog, then dynamic swings, then passing on the move while you can still talk.

Include a few easy block jumps and a short reaction game. If the first contact of the lesson is a full spike, the session started too late.



Warm-up movement should look like the game: short steps, hands ready, eyes on the next ball.

KEY POINTS

- Pulse raiser, then shoulders and calves.
- Passing on the move before isolated hitting.
- A few controlled jumps, not a dunk contest.
- Check the floor for dust and stray balls.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Try this

1. Lead 60 seconds of easy jogging plus shoulder circles.
2. Pairs: 20 forearm passes while side-stepping.
3. Name one muscle group you felt and why it matters at the net.

WATCH OUT

Static long holds at the start cool you down. Save them for the end.

COACH'S TIP

If you can still talk in full sentences, the first two minutes are about right.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What are the two jobs of a volleyball warm-up?
2. When should you first jump in the lesson?
3. Why check the floor?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

1.3 Ball control

The forearm pass (the platform) is still the most important Year 8 skill. Thumbs together, elbows straight, angle the platform. The ball should rise in a friendly arc to the setter, not a rocket at the ceiling.

The overhead set is a catch that is not a catch: contact above the forehead, both hands, a quick spring. A double-hit set is usually two different sounds. Listen.



A still platform sends the ball where the setter already is, not where you wish they were.

KEY POINTS

- Platform: flat, still, angled to the target.
- Set: above the forehead, two hands, one sound.
- Move your feet first. Hands last.
- A playable pass is better than a heroic one.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Try this

1. Wall work: 20 platforms, then 20 sets.
2. Trios: pass, set, catch. Then pass, set, pass back.
3. Call the target before the ball arrives.

WATCH OUT

Swinging the arms on a pass sends the ball sideways and into the next court.

COACH'S TIP

The first contact is a gift to the setter. Make it boring and accurate.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What makes a platform?
2. Where should a set be contacted?
3. Why move the feet before the hands?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

1.4 Attacking skills

Attacking in Year 8 is approach, jump, contact, land. The last two steps are quick-quick. Contact the ball in front of the hitting shoulder. Snap, do not hook.

A tip is an attack. When the block is huge or the set is tight, a soft touch into space is the intelligent shot. The landing is part of the skill: two feet, knees soft, ready for the next ball.



The last two steps create the height. The landing protects the next rally.

KEY POINTS

- Approach, jump, high contact, soft landing.
- A tip is a decision, not a panic.
- Hit the ball, then look for the next one.
- Do not start the approach if the set is already past you.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Try this

1. Shadow the four-step approach ten times without a ball.
2. Standing spikes into a target zone, then add the approach.
3. 3 v 3: every attack must be either a controlled spike or a called tip.

WATCH OUT

Landing on one foot under the net is how ankles are lost.

COACH'S TIP

The set tells you the shot. A tight set is a tip or a roll, not a hero swing.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What are the four parts of an attack?
2. When is a tip the right attack?
3. What should a landing look like?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.5

1.5 Defensive skills

Defence starts before the opponent hits. Ready stance: knees bent, weight forward, hands in front. A dig is a platform under pressure. Get the ball up, not pretty.

Blocking is a job, not a jump. Take away one angle. Hands reach over, not back. The player behind the block must be ready for the deflection.



A block that takes one angle gives the diggers a smaller problem.

KEY POINTS

- Ready before the hit, not after.
- Dig: get it up.
- Block one angle, not the whole net.
- Cover the block.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.5

Try this

1. Pepper in threes: pass, set, controlled hit, dig.
2. Pair blocking: jump, take the line, land, talk.
3. Freeze a 6 v 6 and point to who is covering the block.

WATCH OUT

Watching the hitter with straight legs means the dig is already late.

COACH'S TIP

Your first defensive job is to be in the right square. Hands come second.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the ready stance?
2. What does a block try to take away?
3. Who covers a deflection?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.6

1.6 Game strategies

Year 8 offence needs a designated setter. A 5-1 or a simple 6-6 still works if everyone knows who takes the second ball. Receive in a W or a compact three. Do not all stand on the attack line.

On defence, talk the free ball. A gentle return is an invitation to run a full three-contact attack. On a tough serve, the job is only to keep the ball off the floor.



A receive shape with a named setter turns three random contacts into an offence.

KEY POINTS

- Someone is the setter. Everyone else knows it.
- Receive shape before the serve.
- A free ball is an attack opportunity.
- Seams between passers are where serves live.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.6

Try this

1. Name the setter before every rally for a whole game.
2. Practise W receive against underhand serves.
3. Freeze and point to the seam the server should attack.

WATCH OUT

Two people setting the same ball is how easy points disappear.

COACH'S TIP

The extra player in volleyball is the one who is not passing. Get them to the net.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is a free ball?
2. Why name a setter?
3. Where do smart serves go?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.7

1.7 Game scenarios

Play short, spoken scenarios: side-out at 24-24, receiving after a rotation error, playing with a substitute who has just come on. Keep them to one problem.

Conditioned games build habits: three contacts required, or no jump attack, or the setter must touch every second ball.



Close sets reward the team that still passes to the setter.

KEY POINTS

- One constraint per game.
- Speak the score before the serve.
- Rotate substitutes with a job.
- Reset the serving order after every stoppage.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.7

Try this

1. Start every set at 23-23.
2. Required three contacts, otherwise replay.
3. A substitute must make the first call of their next rally.

WATCH OUT

Blaming the new substitute is a leadership fail.

COACH'S TIP

24-24 is just another rally with better posture.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Why require three contacts in a teaching game?
2. What should a substitute be told as they enter?
3. What happens at 24-24 in rally scoring?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.8

1.8 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down shoulders, calves and the lower back. Volleyball is jumps plus sudden stops.

Reflection is a team act. Who talked, who hid, and what the next match needs more of. Write one communication target.



The court is packed away by the same team that just played on it.

KEY POINTS

- Shoulder and calf care.
- Team reflection, not only personal.
- One communication target.
- Net and balls packed as a team.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.8

Try this

1. Team circle: one keep, one change.
2. Shoulder stretch in pairs, carefully.
3. Write the serving order for the next lesson while it is still in your head.

WATCH OUT

Leaving the net half-wound is how the next class starts late.

COACH'S TIP

The quietest player on court is a tactical problem. Include them on purpose.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Which body parts need extra care after volleyball?
2. What belongs in a team reflection?
3. Why write the serving order down?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.9

1.9 Collective assessment

The collective assessment is a match. Teachers watch first contact, the three-contact habit, movement to the ball, talk, rotation discipline and fair play.

You cannot hide on a six-person court. That is the point. Isolated drills may support the picture, but the game is the evidence.



Collective assessment watches the whole six, including the player who never spikes.

KEY POINTS

- Serve receive and first contact.
- Three-contact habit.
- Rotation and serving order.
- Talk and encouragement.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.9

Try this

1. Play a short assessed set.
2. Self-score talk from 1 to 4.
3. Name the job you will do if you are not the hitter.

WATCH OUT

Avoiding serve receive is visible from any chair.

COACH'S TIP

Be the person who makes the first contact playable. Teams remember that player.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the main assessment event?
2. Which habit is watched besides the spike?
3. What job exists if you are not attacking?



UNIT 2 • TERM 1

Cross Country

Endurance running over natural ground. Year 8 asks for a race plan, not only a brave first minute.

UNIT 2

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain the purpose, course rules and team scoring of cross country.
- ✓ Identify terrain types and apply outdoor safety.
- ✓ Use efficient posture, hill technique and even pacing.
- ✓ Build endurance through easy running and simple intervals.
- ✓ Apply start, pack and finish strategies.
- ✓ Reflect on effort and set a realistic endurance goal.



Cross-country courses use grass, trails and hills. The ground changes, so your stride and breathing must change with it.

Topics in this unit

2.1 Introduction and rules

2.2 Warm-ups

2.3 Running techniques

2.4 Endurance development

2.5 Race strategies

2.6 Game scenarios

2.7 Cool-down and reflection

2.8 Individual assessment

Fitness this unit develops

- Cardiovascular endurance
- Stamina
- Leg strength
- Balance
- Coordination
- Mental resilience

Sporting values

- Stay on the marked route.
- Give space at bottlenecks.
- Encourage the last runner as well as the first.
- Leave the trail as you found it.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

2.1 Introduction and rules

Cross-country running is racing over natural ground: grass, trails, hills and sometimes mud. World Athletics still treats it as a senior discipline. In school it is also the year's clearest test of pacing and honesty.

The rules are simple and strict. Follow the marked course. Do not cut. Give space at the start. Help a fallen runner if they are hurt, then report it. Team events often add finishing places. The fifth finisher can change the total.

Read the course before you race it. Where is the climb? Where can you recover? Where does the path narrow?



Flags and a changing surface are the course. The stopwatch is second.

KEY POINTS

- Stay on the marked route.
- Mass start: controlled, not a sprint into a bottleneck.
- Team scores often add places.
- Kit: suitable shoes, no headphones, water before and after.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

Try this

1. Walk 200 m of the course and name three surface changes.
2. Write the start routine: jog, strides, line-up, first 30 seconds.
3. Explain why cutting a corner is both unsafe and unfair.

WATCH OUT

A fast first 100 m on a narrow path causes falls. Win the race later.

COACH'S TIP

Cross country is not about who starts fastest. It is about who manages pace and finishes strong.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the main rule of a marked course?
2. How can a team score?
3. What should you do in the first 30 seconds?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

2.2 Warm-ups

A cross-country warm-up is longer than a court warm-up. Easy jogging, mobility for hips and calves, then a few strides that rehearse start pace without becoming a race.

Check laces, number if you have one, and the first turning flag. The warm-up ends when you know how the first minute should feel.



Strides on grass rehearse the first minute. They are not a private race.

KEY POINTS

- Longer pulse raiser than indoor sports.
- Strides, not a hidden race.
- Laces, kit, first turn.
- Arrive at the line warm, not gasping.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Try this

1. Lead a 4-minute easy jog plus two 60 m strides.
2. Partner-check laces and kit.
3. Walk the first 30 seconds of the route and name the first decision.

WATCH OUT

Sprinting the strides because someone else did is how the race starts early.

COACH'S TIP

The warm-up is the first page of the race plan.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Why is this warm-up longer?
2. What is a stride for?
3. What three things do you check before the line?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

2.3 Running techniques

Posture: tall chest, slight forward lean from the ankles, arms at about 90 degrees. Cadence is quicker on the way up a hill. The stride shortens. Do not lean from the waist.

Downhill is a skill. Sit a little, let the slope help, keep the feet under you. Braking on every step costs more than a controlled faster descent.



A short uphill stride keeps the chest open. The arms do more work than the ego.

KEY POINTS

- Tall on the flat, shorter on the climb.
- Arms drive the hill.
- Descend under you, not behind you.
- Eyes up enough to see the next flag.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Try this

1. Film or partner-check posture for 30 seconds of easy running.
2. Run 40 m uphill focusing on short steps, then jog down.
3. Practise a 40 m descent without heel-slamming.

WATCH OUT

Leaning from the waist on a climb shuts the lungs.

COACH'S TIP

The hill is won with rhythm, not with a sudden heroic surge.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What happens to the stride on a climb?
2. Why is braking on every downhill step a problem?
3. Where should the lean come from?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

2.4 Endurance development

Endurance is built on easy running you can talk through. Year 8 adds simple intervals: for example 4 times 2 minutes at a stronger pace with a jog recovery. The body adapts to time on feet first.

Keep a small log: how it felt, how you slept, whether the last interval was honest. Comparing only with the fastest person in the year teaches the wrong lesson.



Easy running looks ordinary. That is the point. The body learns from minutes, not from drama.

KEY POINTS

- Easy running is the base.
- A few honest intervals, not a weekly time trial.
- The talk test still works.
- Write how it felt, not only the time.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Try this

1. Run 8 minutes at talk-test pace, then 4 x 1 minute stronger.
2. Note one sentence after the session.
3. Name a recovery choice you will keep this week.

WATCH OUT

Turning every session into a race is how you arrive at the real race already tired.

COACH'S TIP

If you cannot speak a sentence, the easy run is not easy.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the talk test?
2. Why keep a log besides the time?
3. What is the job of an interval session?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.5

2.5 Race strategies

A Year 8 race plan has three parts: a controlled start, a patient middle, an honest finish. Hills are paid for later. Surges are useful only if you can settle again.

Pack running shares the work into the wind and keeps the pace honest. Passing on a narrow path needs a call, not a shove.



A pack that shares the lead is already using tactics, even on a school field.

KEY POINTS

- Start, settle, finish.
- Hills cost more than they look.
- A pack is a tool, not a clique.
- Call before you pass.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.5

Try this

1. Write a 3-sentence race plan for the school course.
2. Run 6 minutes in a pack of four, changing the lead each minute.
3. Practise a polite pass on a cone-narrowed path.

WATCH OUT

Chasing the first 200 m because the year captain did is how good runners vanish by the hill.

COACH'S TIP

The race is usually decided after the last climb, not at the first flag.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What are the three parts of a race plan?
2. Why do hills change the plan?
3. How should you pass on a narrow path?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.6

2.6 Game scenarios

Scenarios teach decisions: a mass start into a gate, a relay exchange, a teammate who has gone off too fast. Keep them short and spoken.

Relays need a clear box and a safe exchange. The incoming runner is tired and less accurate. The outgoing runner must see them early.



A relay exchange is a skill. Tired hands need a bigger target.

KEY POINTS

- One problem per scenario.
- Relay boxes are marked and respected.
- The fifth team finisher still matters.
- Reset after every practice start.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.6

Try this

1. Practise a standing mass start without touching.
2. Relay: four runners, one sash, a marked box.
3. After a 3-minute effort, name one decision you would change.

WATCH OUT

A messy exchange drops more time than a slightly slower leg.

COACH'S TIP

The person who looks back early makes the exchange look easy.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What must a relay box do?
2. Why can the fifth finisher change a team score?
3. What should the outgoing runner do?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.7

2.7 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down by walking until the world stops spinning, then stretch calves, quads and hip flexors. Hills leave those tissues short.

Reflection: score your start, climb, descent and finish from 1 to 4. One number you will change next time.



The last five minutes protect the next run as much as they close this one.

KEY POINTS

- Walk before you sit.
- Calves, quads, hip flexors.
- Four-part reflection.
- Water and a layer before you get cold.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.7

Try this

1. Walk 3 minutes, then a 20-second hold each side.
2. Score start, climb, descent, finish.
3. Write one sentence you would tell next week's self.

WATCH OUT

Sitting down at once after a hard finish makes some people dizzy.

COACH'S TIP

The session is not over until the pulse is down and the next target is written.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Why walk before stretching?
2. Which muscle groups need extra care?
3. What four parts belong in the reflection?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.8

2.8 Individual assessment

Individual assessment looks at technique, etiquette and how you support others, as well as the time. A goal about how you will run is more useful than a goal about beating one person.

You will run a marked course. Teachers watch start discipline, hill shape, course honesty and the way you finish.



Assessment watches how you run the course, not only the number on the watch.

KEY POINTS

- Technique, etiquette, support, time.
- A process goal as well as a time goal.
- The course is public even when the effort is personal.
- Help after you finish: do not block the line.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.8

Try this

1. Write one process goal and one time band.
2. Self-score start discipline from 1 to 4.
3. Name how you will leave the finish area clear.

WATCH OUT

Cutting the last corner in front of a teacher is still cutting.

COACH'S TIP

Run the race you practised. Assessment is not a different sport.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is assessed besides the time?
2. What is a process goal?
3. Why keep the finish area clear?



UNIT 3 • TERM 2

Tennis

A racket sport of early preparation and honest scoring. Year 8 builds points, not only rallies.

UNIT 3

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain tennis scoring, court lines and service rules.
- ✓ Identify singles and doubles spaces.
- ✓ Perform forehand, backhand, serve, volley and smash with control.
- ✓ Use split-step recovery and simple singles and doubles tactics.
- ✓ Call lines fairly and keep score aloud.
- ✓ Reflect after match play and set one next stroke.



The ball is only in play for a moment. Feet that arrive early give the racket time to choose.

Topics in this unit

[3.1 Introduction and rules](#)[3.2 Warm-ups](#)[3.3 Groundstrokes](#)[3.4 Attacking strokes](#)[3.5 Footwork and positioning](#)[3.6 Game strategies](#)[3.7 Game scenarios](#)[3.8 Cool-down and reflection](#)[3.9 Collective assessment](#)

Fitness this unit develops

- Speed
- Agility
- Coordination
- Balance
- Reaction time
- Power

Sporting values

- Call the ball fairly, even against yourself.
- Return balls to the server, not at them.
- Shake hands after the last point.
- Look after rackets and balls.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

3.1 Introduction and rules

Tennis is a net game invented in its modern form in nineteenth-century England and now governed by the ITF. Scoring is 15, 30, 40, game. At deuce you must win by two points. A set is usually first to six games, win by two, with a tie-break at 6-6 in many school formats.

The serve starts every point from behind the baseline, diagonally, into the service box. Singles uses the inner sidelines. Doubles uses the outer. Call the score before you serve. Call the lines honestly.



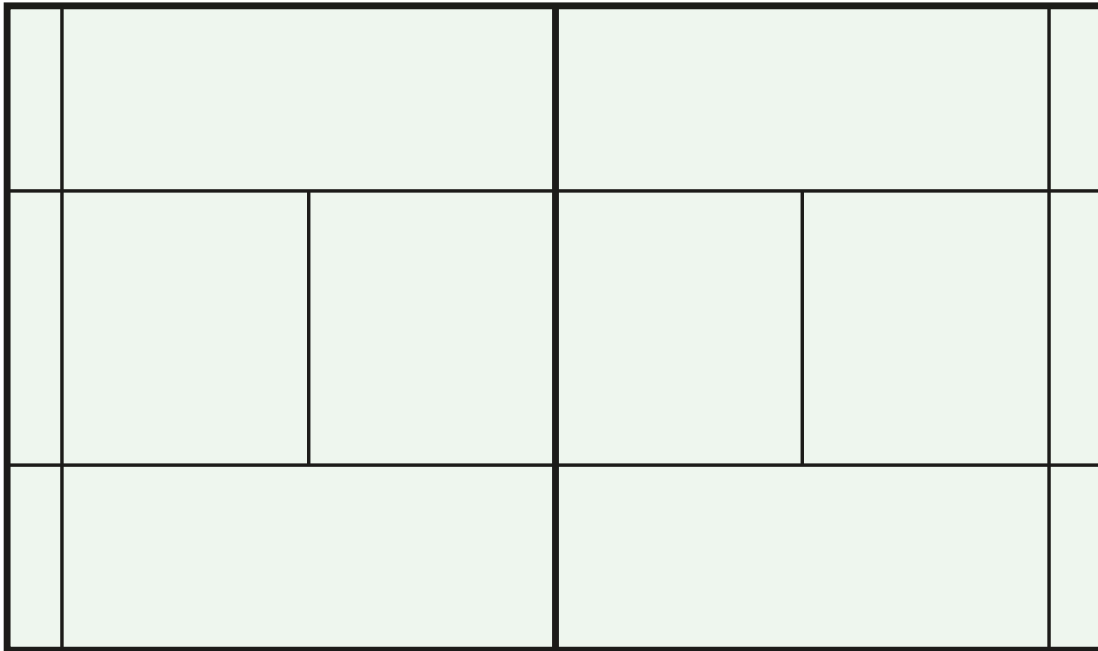
Service boxes and the two widths of sideline: the court is a set of decisions, not a rectangle.

KEY POINTS

- 15, 30, 40, game; deuce is win by two.
- Serve diagonally, behind the baseline.
- Singles is the inner court.
- The server says the score.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Tennis: singles is the inner side lines; doubles uses the outer



Try this

1. Walk the court and name baseline, service line, singles and doubles sidelines.
2. Practise saying the score aloud for a pretend game from 0-0 to deuce.
3. Write one personal target: a stroke, not a trophy.

WATCH OUT

Serving from inside the baseline is a fault, even if the ball was good.

COACH'S TIP

If you cannot keep score, you are not yet playing tennis. You are hitting.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What happens at deuce?
2. Which lines does singles use?
3. Who says the score?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

3.2 Warm-ups

A tennis warm-up is feet first. Jog the doubles tramlines, then split-steps, then shadow swings. Only then do you feed easy balls.

Shoulders, wrists and calves do the work of this sport. Wake them. A rally that starts at match speed is how elbows complain.



A split-step as the opponent hits is the first tennis skill, and it needs no ball.

KEY POINTS

- Pulse, split-step, shadow, then ball.
- Shoulders and calves before serving.
- Easy feeds first.
- Check the court for balls left from the last class.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Try this

1. 20 split-steps in time with a partner's clap.
2. Shadow 10 forehands and 10 backhands.
3. Mini-tennis in the service boxes for 2 minutes.

WATCH OUT

Serving at full speed as the first action of the lesson is a shortcut to a sore arm.

COACH'S TIP

Mini-tennis is not childish. It is how you find timing.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What comes before the first real serve?
2. Why start with mini-tennis?
3. Which joints need extra care?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

3.3 Groundstrokes

The forehand is a low-to-high swing from a side-on stance. Prepare early. Contact in front. Finish over the shoulder. The backhand, one-handed or two, needs the same early unit turn.

Consistency beats decoration. A ball that lands deep in the court twice is better than a winner that you cannot repeat.



A repeatable groundstroke starts with the unit turn, not with a bigger swing.

KEY POINTS

- Early preparation, contact in front.
- Low to high for clearance and spin.
- Recover after every stroke.
- Both wings, not a favourite side only.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Try this

1. 20 forehands to a large target, then 20 backhands.
2. Cross-court rally: 8 in a row before you may go down the line.
3. Weaker-side only for one whole game of mini-tennis.

WATCH OUT

A late backswing turns every ball into an emergency.

COACH'S TIP

The ready position is a skill. Return to it as if it were a stroke.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Where should you contact a groundstroke?
2. Why swing low to high?
3. What should you do after you hit?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

3.4 Attacking strokes

The serve is a throw that uses a racket. Trophy position, toss slightly in front, contact high, land inside the court. First serves can have more pace. Second serves must land.

The volley is a block in front of the body. The smash is an overhead on a short lob. Both need the split-step first.



A useful serve is one you can repeat into the box when the game is 30-40.

KEY POINTS

- Toss you can hit, not a toss you admire.
- Second serve: kick or slice, but in.
- Volley in front, continental grip if you can.
- Smash: move, then swing.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Try this

1. 10 second-serve targets into the backhand box.
2. Approach plus one volley from a partner lob.
3. Count first-serve percentage over 12 attempts.

WATCH OUT

A second serve that is only a slower first serve sits up to be attacked.

COACH'S TIP

Win the point with the next ball after a good serve, not with a wild first ball.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the trophy position?
2. Why must the second serve land?
3. When do you volley rather than let the ball bounce?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.5

3.5 Footwork and positioning

Tennis footwork is a split-step, a first step toward the ball, and a recovery toward the centre (singles) or a shared middle (doubles). Late feet make late rackets.

On a wide ball, get there, hit, then recover. Standing to admire a winner is how the next ball goes past you.



Recovery to the middle is part of the stroke. The highlight reel never shows it.

KEY POINTS

- Split-step as they hit.
- Recover after every ball.
- Singles base is near the centre mark.
- Doubles: one up, one back, or both back by agreement.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.5

Try this

1. Shadow a wide forehand and recover to the centre 10 times.
2. Partner feeds left and right. Split-step on every feed.
3. Doubles: freeze after each shot and check the two positions.

WATCH OUT

Crossing your feet on recovery is how you fall on a change of direction.

COACH'S TIP

The split-step is cheap. Skipping it is expensive.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. When do you split-step?
2. Where is the singles base?
3. What should happen after a wide ball?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.6

3.6 Game strategies

Singles tactics in Year 8 are simple: keep the ball deep, move the opponent, approach only on a short ball. Doubles tactics: the net player poaches with a call, the baseline player covers the gap.

Build points. The extra ball is often the one that wins, not the first aggressive idea.



Doubles is a conversation. The pair that talks owns the middle.

KEY POINTS

- Depth first, then direction.
- Approach on a short ball.
- Doubles: talk before you poach.
- The next ball is the tactic.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.6

Try this

1. Singles: only win a point after the fourth shot.
2. Doubles: the net player must touch one ball every four points.
3. Write a two-shot plan: serve plus first ball.

WATCH OUT

Coming in on a deep ball is a gift to the passer.

COACH'S TIP

A high, deep ball is a tactic. It is not a waste of a point.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. When should you approach the net in singles?
2. What must a doubles poach include?
3. Why does depth matter?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.7

3.7 Game scenarios

Scenarios: 30-40 on your serve, a tie-break to 7, a partner who has missed the last two volleys. Speak them, then play one point at a time.

Conditioned games isolate the skill: no smash, only backhand returns, or serve-and-one-shot.



A short conditioned point teaches one decision at a time.

KEY POINTS

- One constraint per game.
- Say the score every point.
- A tie-break is still tennis.
- Reset between points. Breathe.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.7

Try this

1. Play a 7-point tie-break.
2. Only backhand returns for a six-point game.
3. After each game, one sentence: what worked.

WATCH OUT

Arguing a line call for a minute wastes the only court time you have.

COACH'S TIP

Play the next ball. The last mistake is only useful if it changes the next choice.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is a useful constraint for return practice?
2. How do you start a tie-break?
3. Why say the score every point?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.8

3.8 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down the hitting shoulder, forearm and calves. Easy hitting into the service boxes, then slower stretches.

Reflection: your best point, and the stroke that still wobbles. A worn grip is a safety issue. Change it.



The last five minutes look after the arm that has to serve again on Thursday.

KEY POINTS

- Shoulder and calves.
- Note the best point.
- Check the grip.
- Balls collected as a pair.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.8

Try this

1. Lead a 90-second shoulder stretch.
2. Write keep / change / ask.
3. Count the balls back into the hopper.

WATCH OUT

Leaving loose balls on court is how the next class starts with a rolled ankle.

COACH'S TIP

The session is not over until the hopper is full and the next stroke is named.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Which joints need extra care after tennis?
2. What makes a useful reflection?
3. Why collect every ball?

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.9

3.9 Collective assessment

Collective assessment is a short singles or doubles match plus a score you keep yourselves. Teachers watch serve, groundstrokes, movement, honesty of calls and how you play the next point after a mistake.

A written rules check may support the picture if match evidence is thin.



Assessment evidence is a real match: strokes used while the score is being said.

KEY POINTS

- Serve, rally, movement, fair calls.
- You keep the score.
- The next point after an error.
- Doubles talk if you are assessed as a pair.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.9

Try this

1. Play a six-game pro-set, calling your own lines.
2. Self-score movement from 1 to 4.
3. Name the stroke you will show on purpose.

WATCH OUT

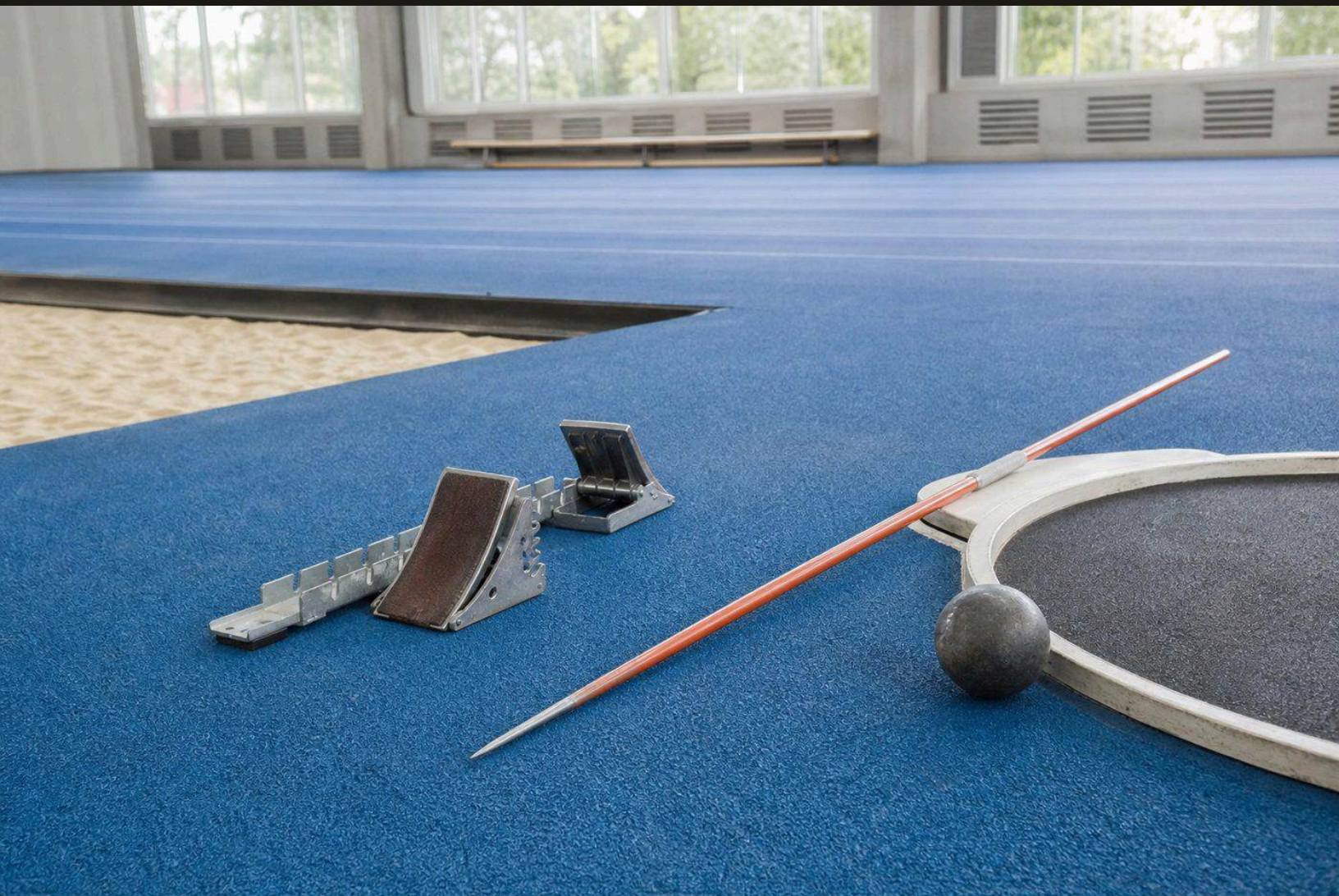
Giving yourself a generous line on a big point is visible, and it is the assessment.

COACH'S TIP

Show the tennis you practised. Assessment is not a new sport.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the main assessment event?
2. What is watched besides winners?
3. Who keeps the score?



UNIT 4 • TERM 2

Athletics

Running, jumping and throwing. Each event has one job: a clean shape that you can repeat.

UNIT 4

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain event rules and safety sectors for running, jumping and throwing.
- ✓ Sprint from a crouch start with a short drive phase.
- ✓ Perform long jump and high jump with a controlled approach.
- ✓ Throw shot, javelin and discus with a safe standing or short approach.
- ✓ Record a personal best honestly.
- ✓ Reflect on technique, not only distance or time.



Athletics rewards the student who measures the next centimetre, not the one who only cheers the winner.

Topics in this unit

[4.1 Introduction and rules](#)[4.2 Warm-ups](#)[4.3 Sprinting](#)[4.4 Long jump](#)[4.5 High jump](#)[4.6 Shot put](#)[4.7 Javelin](#)[4.8 Discus](#)[4.9 Cool-down and reflection](#)[4.10 Individual assessment](#)

Fitness this unit develops

- Speed
- Strength
- Power
- Flexibility
- Coordination
- Balance

Sporting values

- Wait for the all-clear before you throw.
- Measure honestly.
- Cheer a personal best, including someone else's.
- Carry implements, do not throw them in the walk back.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

4.1 Introduction and rules

Athletics is running, jumping and throwing. World Athletics writes the senior rules. School athletics keeps the same ideas with lighter implements, shorter runways and a louder safety culture.

A throw only happens when the sector is clear and a teacher has said so. A jump only happens when the pit or mat is ready. A sprint starts behind the line. Personal bests are recorded honestly.



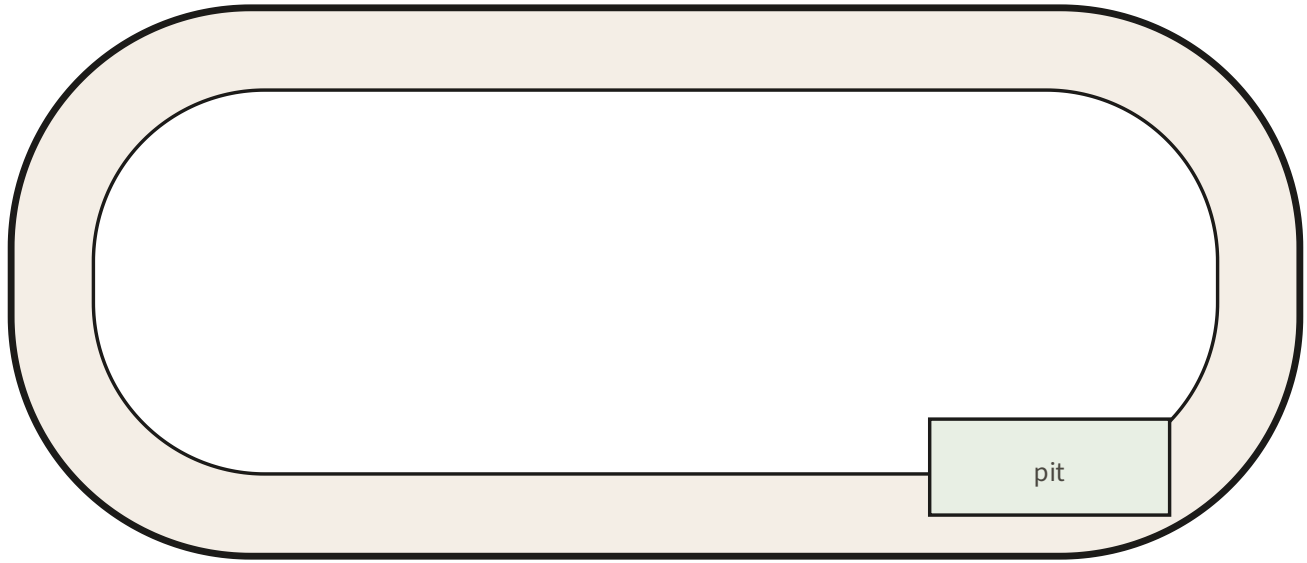
Track, pit and throwing sector: three spaces, three different safety conversations.

KEY POINTS

- Safety sector before every throw.
- Lighter school implements.
- Measure what actually happened.
- One event at a time in the head.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

School track, sand pit and a throwing sector kept well clear

**Try this**

1. Walk the throwing sector and name the safe arc.
2. List the events in this unit and one safety rule for each.
3. Write a personal-best table with empty boxes for later.

WATCH OUT

Collecting a javelin by walking in front of the next thrower is how people are hurt.

COACH'S TIP

The first athletics skill is waiting. The second is the technique.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

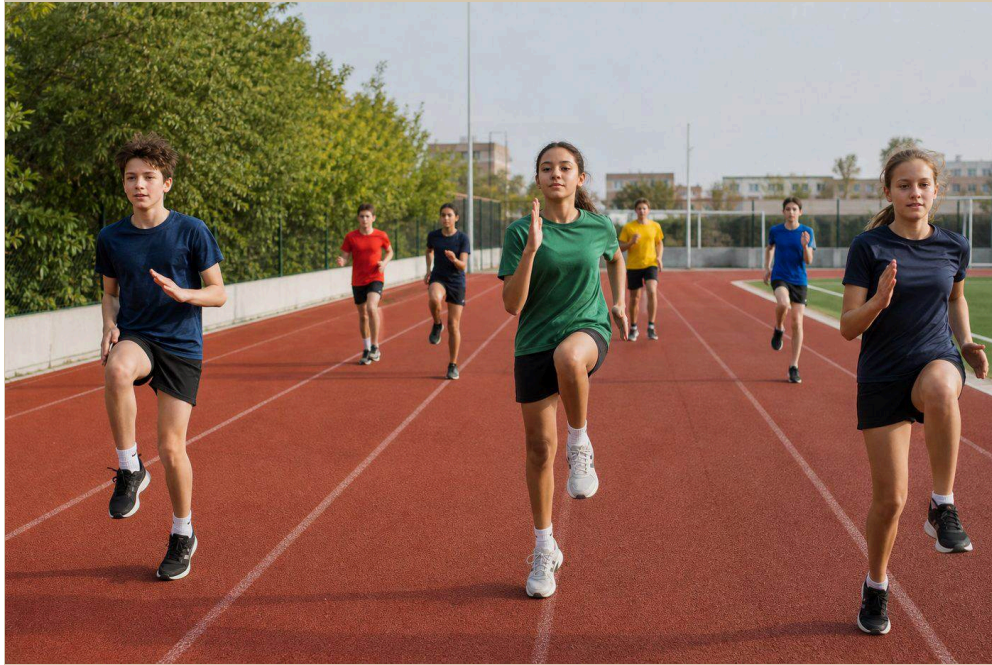
1. Who must be clear before a throw?
2. Why use school implements?
3. What belongs in a personal-best table?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

4.2 Warm-ups

An athletics warm-up is a pulse raiser, then mobility, then event-specific drills: A-skips for sprints, easy bounding for jumps, standing throws with a soft object for field events.

Do not jump or throw hard as the first action. The tissues that produce power need time.



A-skips look small. They are the sprint lesson in slow motion.

KEY POINTS

- Pulse, mobility, specific drills.
- A-skips and marches for sprints.
- Soft standing throws first.
- The runway is not a playground.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Try this

1. Lead 3 minutes of jogging plus A-skips.
2. Hip-openers and ankle circles, 8 each side.
3. Name the specific drill for the event you will do today.

WATCH OUT

A long static hamstring hold at the start reduces the spring you need.

COACH'S TIP

If the first skip is tidy, the first sprint has a chance.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What are the three parts of this warm-up?
2. Which drill belongs to sprinting?
3. Why start throws standing and soft?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

4.3 Sprinting

A crouch start: hands behind the line, front knee above the front foot, hips higher than the head. On go, push the ground away. The first eight to ten steps are the drive phase: low, fast, strong.

Then you rise into a tall sprint. Arms drive. Eyes ahead. Do not look at the person in the next lane. The race is a set of shapes you already own.



A still set position is already a sprint skill. Fidgeting leaks power.

KEY POINTS

- Crouch: stable, loaded, still.
- Drive phase is low and powerful.
- Rise gradually, do not pop up.
- Run in your lane to the line.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Try this

1. Practise the set position for 8 seconds of stillness.
2. 10 m drive-phase sprints, walk back.
3. 30 m from a crouch, partner-check the first six steps.

WATCH OUT

Standing up in the first two steps wastes the start.

COACH'S TIP

The start is a push, not a step. Feel the blocks or the ground go backwards.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the drive phase?
2. Where are the hands in a crouch start?
3. Why stay in your lane after the finish?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

4.4 Long jump

Long jump is an approach, a take-off, a flight and a landing. The board is a target, not a spring. Year 8 uses a short run-up you can repeat. Take off from one foot. Land with both feet reaching forward into the sand.

The last two steps set the jump. A foul is a lesson about the run-up, not a reason to sprint harder next time.



The sand records the landing. The run-up decides whether the jump counts.

KEY POINTS

- Repeatable run-up.
- One-foot take-off near the board, not over it.
- Feet together in the sand, then out the front.
- Rake the pit for the next person.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Try this

1. Mark a 10 to 14 stride run-up and hit it three times without jumping.
2. Short-approach jumps focusing on a tall take-off.
3. Measure one legal jump and write the number.

WATCH OUT

Looking down at the board on the last step drops the hips.

COACH'S TIP

A slightly shorter legal jump is better than a long foul you cannot count.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What are the four parts of a long jump?
2. How should you leave the pit?
3. What does a foul usually tell you?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.5

4.5 High jump

High jump in school may be the scissor or a carefully taught flop onto a proper mat. The bar is a height, not a dare. Approach on a curve for the flop, or a straight angle for the scissor. Land on the mat, not on the floor.

Lower the bar until the shape is clean. Height without a landing plan is not bravery.



The mat is the event. The bar is only a question you ask it.

KEY POINTS

- Mat first, bar second.
- One clear technique, taught, not copied from a video.
- The last three steps set the jump.
- Walk back around the stand, never under the bar.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.5

Try this

1. Scissor at a low height, 6 successful clearances.
2. If flopping, practise the curve without a bar.
3. Name one cue you will keep: knee, lean, or eyes.

WATCH OUT

Trying a flop onto a thin mat is not a Year 8 task.

COACH'S TIP

Clear a height you own. Then add one hole on the stand.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What must be in place before the bar goes up?
2. Why might school use the scissor?
3. How do you walk back after a jump?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.6

4.6 Shot put

Shot put is a push, not a throw. The shot sits against the neck. Chin, knee and toe make a line in the power position. The implement leaves from the fingers, finishing with a long arm.

Year 8 uses a standing put or a short glide. The circle has a stop-board. You must leave from the back of the circle after a legal put.



The power position is a line you can see: chin, knee, toe, then a long finish.

KEY POINTS

- Push from the neck, not a heave from behind the head.
- Chin-knee-toe line.
- Leave the circle to the rear.
- The sector must be empty.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.6

Try this

1. Standing puts into a net or grass sector, 8 on each side if both are taught.
2. Partner-check the neck position before each put.
3. Measure one legal put.

WATCH OUT

Dropping the elbow turns a put into a dangerous slinging action.

COACH'S TIP

The legs start the put. The arm finishes it.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Where does the shot sit?
2. How must you leave the circle?
3. Why is a dropped elbow a problem?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.7

4.7 Javelin

School javelin is often a foam or rubber training implement on a short runway. The point, if there is one, travels in a marked sector. The throw is a long pull over a braced front leg, not a cricket bowl.

Carry the implement vertical when you walk. Collect it only when the teacher says the sector is closed.



A training javelin still needs an empty sector. The rule does not get lighter with the implement.

KEY POINTS

- Training implement, marked sector.
- Long pull, braced front leg.
- Walk, do not throw, on the way back.
- One thrower at a time.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.7

Try this

1. Standing throws focusing on a high finish.
2. Three-step approach, same finish.
3. Practise the carry and the collection as a drill of their own.

WATCH OUT

Turning to talk with the javelin on your shoulder points it at someone.

COACH'S TIP

If the implement lands tail-first, the release was late or low. Fix the shape, not the run-up speed.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What kind of implement does Year 8 use?
2. When do you collect a throw?
3. What does a tail-first landing tell you?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.8

4.8 Discus

Discus is a slinging throw from a circle, ideally with a cage. Year 8 starts with a standing throw: wind, unwind, release off the index finger so the discus flies flat.

Do not chase a full spin until the standing throw is safe and repeatable. The cage is not optional decoration.



The cage is part of the event. A pretty spin without it is not a better throw.

KEY POINTS

- Standing throw first.
- Flat release off the finger.
- Cage and empty sector.
- Leave the circle to the rear after a legal throw.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.8

Try this

1. Bowl a discus along the grass to feel the spin.
2. 8 standing throws, partner watching the release.
3. Name the cage rule in one sentence.

WATCH OUT

A full spin copied from a video, in a school circle with no cage, is not a Year 8 task.

COACH'S TIP

A flat standing throw that lands in the sector is already athletics.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Why start standing?
2. What should the discus do in the air?
3. Why does a cage exist?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.9

4.9 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down hips, throwing shoulder and calves. Field events leave you tight in places court sports do not.

Reflection: one number (time, height, distance) and one shape you will keep. Park implements before you sit.



Implements travel back in hands, not in the air. That is the last technique of the day.

KEY POINTS

- Shoulder and hips.
- Implements parked first.
- A number and a shape.
- Thank the people who raked and measured.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.9

Try this

1. Lead a 90-second hip and shoulder stretch.
2. Write number / shape / next cue.
3. Check the sector is clear and the pit is raked.

WATCH OUT

Leaving a shot on the grass because you are chatting is still leaving a shot on the grass.

COACH'S TIP

The session ends when the equipment is asleep, not when your best throw landed.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Which tissues need extra care after field events?
2. What two things belong in the reflection?
3. Where do implements go?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.10

4.10 Individual assessment

Individual assessment is a small cluster of events: one sprint, one jump, one throw, plus the safety habits around them. Teachers watch the shape as well as the number.

You will record your own marks. A written rules check may support the picture if weather stops the field.



A tape on a legal mark is the evidence. The shape that produced it is the lesson.

KEY POINTS

- One run, one jump, one throw.
- Safety is assessed.
- You record the mark.
- Technique can outrank a lucky big number.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.10

Try this

1. Choose your three events and write the cue for each.
2. Self-score safety from 1 to 4.
3. Measure and write one legal mark in each.

WATCH OUT

Saving a wild new technique for assessment day is how marks disappear.

COACH'S TIP

Show the event you own. The extra spin can wait.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. How many event types are assessed?
2. What is assessed besides the mark?
3. Who writes the number down?



UNIT 5 • TERM 3

Rugby

Touch rugby: a fast invasion game. Pass backwards, support outside, and defend as a line.

UNIT 5

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain the history and school rules of touch rugby.
- ✓ Pass and catch on the move, backwards, with two hands.
- ✓ Create an overlap and support the ball carrier.
- ✓ Defend as a connected line and make a safe two-handed touch.
- ✓ Communicate, lead and reset after a turnover.
- ✓ Reflect after a match and name one team habit.



The ball can only travel backwards. The attack therefore lives in the space beside the ball carrier, not behind them.

Topics in this unit

5.1 Introduction and rules

5.2 Warm-ups

5.3 Ball handling

5.4 Attacking skills

5.5 Defensive skills

5.6 Game strategies

5.7 Game scenarios

5.8 Cool-down and reflection

5.9 Collective assessment

Fitness this unit develops

- Agility
- Speed
- Strength
- Coordination
- Endurance
- Reaction time

Sporting values

- The touch is two hands, not a shove.
- Pass to the person who is free, not only to a friend.
- Help a player who has just been touched.
- Stop at once if someone is hurt.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.1

5.1 Introduction and rules

Rugby grew in nineteenth-century English schools. The World Rugby laws describe the full contact game. Year 8 at this school plays touch rugby: a two-handed touch replaces the tackle. The ball may not be thrown forwards. A try is scored by grounding the ball over the try line.

A typical school game is six or seven a side on a marked grid. Six touches, then a turnover, is a common condition. Mouthguards if the department asks. No boots with dangerous studs on a hard surface. Jewellery off.



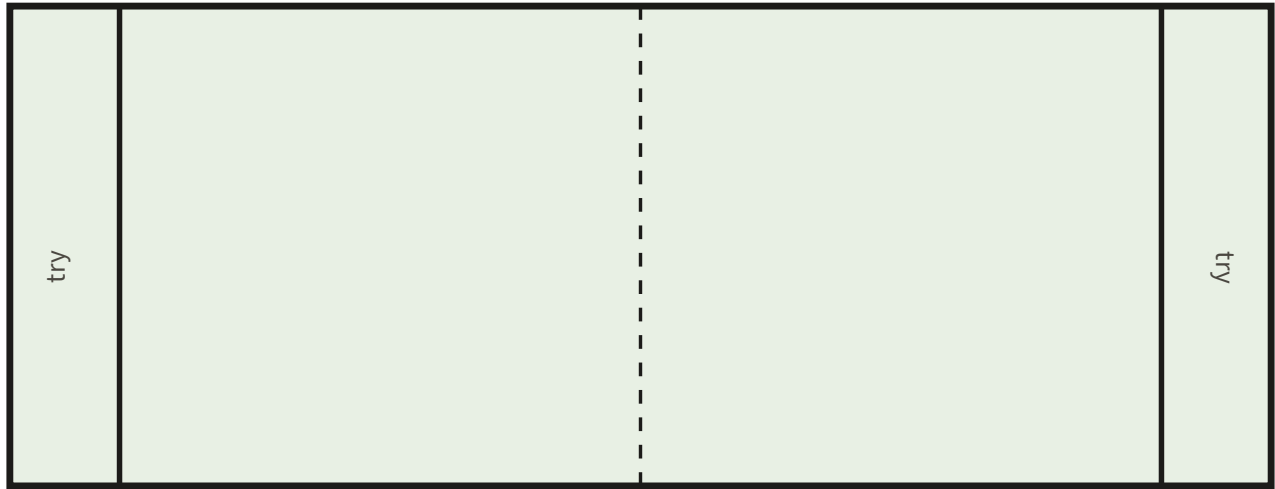
Cones, a try line and a size 4 ball: the field is small so the decisions stay close.

KEY POINTS

- Pass backwards or flat, never forwards.
- Two-handed touch, then play the ball.
- Six touches then turnover, unless the teacher says otherwise.
- A try is a ground, not a dive at someone's knees.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.1

Touch rugby grid: try lines, in-goal, halfway

**Try this**

1. Walk the grid and name try line, touchline and in-goal.
2. Practise a two-handed touch that is a touch, not a shove.
3. Write one safety rule in your own words.

WATCH OUT

A one-handed slap is not a touch. It is an argument waiting to happen.

COACH'S TIP

If you can explain the offside line after a touch, you are ready to play.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What replaces the tackle in this unit?
2. Which way may the ball be passed?
3. How is a try scored?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.2

5.2 Warm-ups

A rugby warm-up is running shapes plus passing on the move. Side shuffles, changes of direction, then pairs passing backwards while they jog.

Fingers and hips need to be awake. The first drill should not be a full-speed 7 v 7.



Passing on the move is the warm-up because it is also the game.

KEY POINTS

- Pulse raiser with changes of direction.
- Passing on the move, backwards.
- Two-handed touch practice at walking pace.
- Check the grid for holes and stray bags.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.2

Try this

1. Lead 60 seconds of shuffles and skips.
2. Pairs: 20 passes on the move, both ways.
3. Walking 3 v 2 to rehearse the touch.

WATCH OUT

A static long stretch at the start is the wrong temperature for this game.

COACH'S TIP

If the first pass of the lesson is backwards, the lesson has started correctly.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What two things belong in this warm-up?
2. Why pass while jogging, not standing?
3. What do you check on the grid?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.3

5.3 Ball handling

Catch with two hands, thumbs ready, eyes on the ball until it is yours. The spin pass starts at the hip and finishes with fingers pointing at the target. The ball must travel backwards relative to the passer.

A pop pass is shorter and faster for a support runner close in. Switch-pass work so both sides of the body can give the ball.



Fingers at the target after a spin pass. The ball is already someone else's problem.

KEY POINTS

- Two hands to catch.
- Spin pass: hip to target, ball goes backwards.
- Pop pass for the close runner.
- Both sides, not a favourite hand only.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.3

Try this

1. Static pairs: 20 spin passes each way.
2. On the move in threes, ball staying behind the passer.
3. Weaker-side only for one whole square.

WATCH OUT

A one-handed fancy catch that is dropped is just a dropped ball.

COACH'S TIP

The pass is successful when the receiver can run. A pretty spiral that they cannot catch is a turnover.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. When is a pass forward?
2. What is a pop pass for?
3. Why two hands?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.4

5.4 Attacking skills

Attacking in touch rugby is about fixing a defender and releasing a teammate into space. Run at a player, commit them, then pass. The support runner stays behind the ball until the moment of the pass, then accelerates outside.

A dummy is a lie the body tells. Use it sparingly. A switch or a loop can create an overlap if the defence is sliding too early.



An overlap is a picture: one extra attacker on the edge, created by a committed defender.

KEY POINTS

- Fix, then pass.
- Support from behind and outside.
- Width stretches a line.
- A dummy only works if you can also pass.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.4

Try this

1. 2 v 1: fix and pass. First to five clean breaks.
2. 3 v 2: name the extra player before you start.
3. Freeze a 5 v 5 and point to the overlap.

WATCH OUT

Running across your own support is how overlaps die.

COACH'S TIP

The extra player is the attack. Find them with the pass you have.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What does it mean to fix a defender?
2. Where should the support runner stand?
3. What is an overlap?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.5

5.5 Defensive skills

Defence is a line. Players stay connected, move up together, and make a two-handed touch on the ball carrier. After a touch, retreat to the offside line so the next play can start.

Do not dive in. Show the attacker toward the touchline. Talk: I have the ball, you have the next pass.



A connected defensive line leaves no easy split pass. The touch is the full stop.

KEY POINTS

- A connected line, not a collection of chases.
- Two hands, then reset.
- Show them to the side.
- Talk the next receiver.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.5

Try this

1. Walking defence: stay in a line of four for 20 m.
2. 2 v 2: the second defender covers the pass.
3. After every touch, the whole line retreats on a call.

WATCH OUT

A hero rush out of the line opens a door the size of a teammate.

COACH'S TIP

Good defenders defend the next pass, not only the player who already has the ball.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What should the line do after a touch?
2. Why stay connected?
3. What are the two hands for?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.6

5.6 Game strategies

Year 8 tactics: use the width of the grid, change the point of attack after two touches, and kick only if the teacher has allowed a controlled grubber in space. Most school games are better without a kick.

On the last touch, play a safe pass and reset, or have a called move. Silence at the last touch is how turnovers happen.



Width first. The defence that has just slid one way is late to the other.

KEY POINTS

- Width, then a change of side.
- A plan for the last touch.
- Kicks only if taught and allowed.
- The captain talks the next shape.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.6

Try this

1. 5 v 5: after two touches you must switch the side.
2. Practise a last-touch reset pass.
3. Name a captain for 3 minutes, then swap.

WATCH OUT

A hopeful kick into a crowd is a turnover you chose.

COACH'S TIP

The best tactic is often the extra player you already have, used now.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What should happen after two touches?
2. What is a last-touch plan?
3. When is a kick acceptable in this unit?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.7

5.7 Game scenarios

Scenarios: six-touch count shown on fingers, a tap restart, a player who has just come on. Speak them, then play.

Conditioned games: two-touch, weaker-side pass, or no dummy. Small-sided first, then 7 v 7.



A six-touch count that everyone can see is already a tactic.

KEY POINTS

- Show the touch count.
- One constraint per game.
- Everyone plays, everyone touches the ball.
- Stop to coach one picture, then play on.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.7

Try this

1. 4 v 4, two-touch. First to three tries.
2. The attacking team must use a weaker-side pass once per set.
3. After each game, one sentence from each team: what worked.

WATCH OUT

Turning a teaching game into an argument about a touch wastes the only grass time you have.

COACH'S TIP

Play the next ball. The last touch is only useful if it changes the next choice.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Why show the touch count on fingers?
2. Why start 4 v 4 before 7 v 7?
3. How should roles rotate?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.8

5.8 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down hips, groin and the passing shoulder. Touch rugby is sudden stops plus rotation.

Reflection: who talked, who hid, and whether the last touch had a plan. Thank the people you played with.



The field is packed away by the same team that just attacked on it.

KEY POINTS

- Hips and shoulder.
- Team reflection.
- One communication target.
- Cones in, balls in.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.8

Try this

1. Team circle: one keep, one change.
2. 90-second hip stretch.
3. Write the restart you will use next lesson.

WATCH OUT

Leaving cones on the field is how the next class starts late.

COACH'S TIP

The quietest attacker is a tactical problem. Give them the first pass next time.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Which tissues need extra care?
2. What belongs in a team reflection?
3. Why pack the cones?

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.9

5.9 Collective assessment

Collective assessment is a match. Teachers watch passing under pressure, support lines, defensive connection, two-handed touches, talk and fair play.

Isolated passing may support the picture, but the game is the evidence.



Assessment watches the whole line, including the player who never scores.

KEY POINTS

- Pass, support, line, touch, talk.
- The game is the test.
- Fair play is visible.
- A process focus word helps: fix, width, or reset.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.9

Try this

1. Play a short assessed match.
2. Self-score talk from 1 to 4.
3. Name your focus word.

WATCH OUT

Hiding on the wing for the whole assessment is visible from any sideline.

COACH'S TIP

Play the rugby you practised. Assessment is not a different sport.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the main assessment event?
2. Which habits are watched besides scoring?
3. What is a focus word for?



UNIT 6 • TERM 3

Sports Aerobics

High-energy movement to music. Year 8 routines last longer and must stay together as a group.

UNIT 6

In this unit you will

- ✓ Explain the purpose, safety and school competition format of sports aerobics.
- ✓ Perform basic steps on both leads in time with music.
- ✓ Show simple strength and flexibility elements with control.
- ✓ Build and perform an individual and a group routine.
- ✓ Work with others on timing and spacing.
- ✓ Reflect on performance quality, not only energy.



Sports aerobics is not only fitness. It is controlled movement, clear shapes and teamwork with the music.

Topics in this unit

[6.1 Introduction and rules](#)[6.2 Warm-ups](#)[6.3 Basic skills](#)[6.4 Strength elements](#)[6.5 Flexibility](#)[6.6 Routine building](#)[6.7 Performance](#)[6.8 Cool-down and reflection](#)[6.9 Individual assessment](#)

Fitness this unit develops

- Flexibility
- Strength
- Balance
- Coordination
- Rhythm
- Muscular endurance

Sporting values

- Give other groups a quiet space to rehearse.
- Count the music together.
- Support a classmate who is learning a new step.
- Finish the routine even if a move goes wrong.

Look at the space

Before the first drill, name what you already know. Equipment, lines, hazards, the first rule you will keep.

Write one personal target that is a skill, not a score.

Year 8 is the year you start to coach the person next to you with one precise sentence, not a shrug.



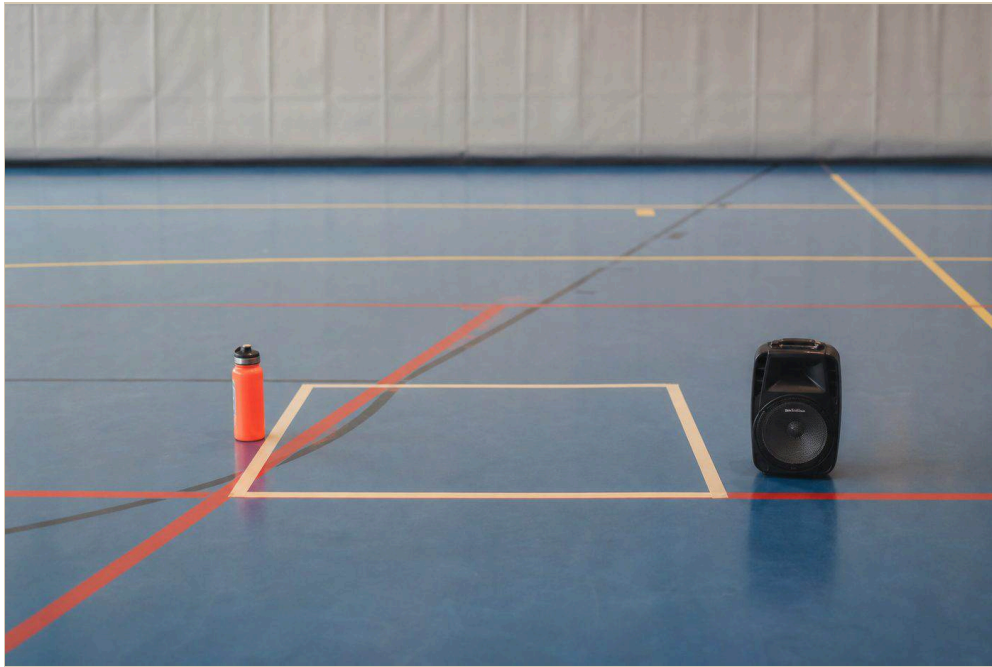
This is the space and the action of the unit. Name what you see before the first drill.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.1

6.1 Introduction and rules

Sports aerobics is a judged fitness sport in the FIG family of gymnastics. In school it is a way to train rhythm, strength, flexibility and performance without a full apparatus hall.

Safety is the first rule: land softly, knees in line with toes, never force a flexibility shape. Music is a partner, not a race. Year 8 routines are a little longer than Year 7, but quality of shape still beats a long sequence that falls apart.



A clear floor, a speaker and enough space: the equipment list is short on purpose.

KEY POINTS

- Control first, then speed.
- Land softly, joints stacked.
- Music has counts. Learn them.
- Know your personal square.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.1

Try this

1. Clap an 8-count and step on each beat.
2. Mark a 2 m square of personal space with cones.
3. Write one safety rule in your own words.

WATCH OUT

Comparing your flexibility to the most mobile person in the room is how people get hurt.

COACH'S TIP

If the shape is ugly at slow speed, it will not become beautiful when the music is loud.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What does FIG have to do with this unit?
2. Why are routines still kept fairly short?
3. What is an 8-count?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.2

6.2 Warm-ups

Aerobic warm-ups follow the music from the start. March, step-touch, grapevine, easy hamstring and hip openers, then a little faster.

Include wrist and ankle circles if the lesson will contain floor strength elements.



A group warm-up is already a rehearsal of timing and spacing.

KEY POINTS

- Move with the music immediately.
- Raise pulse, then mobilise.
- Rehearse the basic steps you will use.
- Check the floor for slip hazards.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.2

Try this

1. Follow an 8 x 8 warm-up led by a classmate.
2. Step-touch for two 8-counts, then grapevine for two.
3. Spot and remove one floor hazard.

WATCH OUT

Socks on a polished floor are not a style choice. Wear the shoes you were asked to wear.

COACH'S TIP

If you can smile and keep the count, the warm-up pace is right.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Which basic steps belong in a warm-up?
2. Why check the floor?
3. When should wrists be mobilised?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.3

6.3 Basic skills

Basic aerobic skills are the vocabulary: march, jog, skip, knee lift, kick, jumping jack, step-touch, grapevine and a simple turn. Each has a clear arm pattern so the whole body reads as one phrase.

Learn them on the right lead and the left lead. Routines that only travel one way look unfinished.



A finished shape has still hands for a moment, even in a fast routine.

KEY POINTS

- Clear feet, clear arms.
- Both leads.
- Stay on the count.
- Finish each shape.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.3

Try this

1. Perform each basic step for one 8-count.
2. Link four steps into a 4 x 8 phrase.
3. Teach your phrase to another pair.

WATCH OUT

Floppy arms make even good footwork look accidental.

COACH'S TIP

Hit the shape on the count, then move. Do not smear one step into the next.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Name five basic aerobic steps.
2. Why practise both leads?
3. What does finish the shape mean?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.4

6.4 Strength elements

Strength elements in school aerobics are controlled: a strong plank, a clean press-up, a tucked jump, a controlled squat. They are held or landed, not flung.

If you cannot do a full press-up, use a box or knee variation with the same body line. The line is the skill.



The strength element is the body line. Light equipment is enough.

KEY POINTS

- Stacked joints.
- A hold is still a performance.
- Land, then be still. Do not collapse.
- Choose the variation you can control.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.4

Try this

1. 10-second plank with a straight line, twice.
2. 5 controlled squat jumps, quiet landings.
3. Press-up variation: 6 reps, partner-check the line.

WATCH OUT

A banana back in a plank is not a stronger plank. It is a different, worse shape.

COACH'S TIP

Strength in this unit is visible stillness. Anyone can shake.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What makes a plank a performance element?
2. When should you choose a variation?
3. What should a landing look like?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.5

6.5 Flexibility

Flexibility is a range you can control. Dynamic swings to warm, then short holds. Never bounce into pain. Hips, hamstrings and shoulders matter most.

A kick is a flexibility skill only if the standing leg is still and the hips stay level.



A controlled kick keeps the standing hip quiet. The height is secondary.

KEY POINTS

- Warm before you hold.
- Level hips on kicks.
- Breathe in the hold.
- No bouncing into pain.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.5

Try this

1. Standing hamstring hinge, 20 seconds each side.
2. Controlled front kick, 6 each leg, hips level.
3. Shoulder flex with a band or towel, 20 seconds.

WATCH OUT

Comparing kick height is the fastest way to lose the standing-leg skill.

COACH'S TIP

Height without control is just a fall that has not happened yet.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the difference between dynamic and held flexibility?
2. What should the standing leg do during a kick?
3. Why is bouncing a bad idea?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.6

6.6 Routine building

A Year 8 routine is 48 to 80 counts: a start shape, travelling phrases, one strength or flexibility moment, and a finish shape that you actually hold. Groups add unison and a simple formation change.

Write the counts down. Paper prevents arguments and lets you rehearse without the speaker.



Choreography on paper looks unromantic. It is how groups stay together.

KEY POINTS

- Start and finish are part of the dance.
- Travel, highlight, close.
- Write the counts.
- Leave space between bodies.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.6

Try this

1. Draft a 6 x 8 individual routine.
2. In threes, build an 8 x 8 group routine with one highlight and one formation change.
3. Rehearse once without music, counting aloud.

WATCH OUT

Copying a social-media routine you cannot land is not choreography.

COACH'S TIP

If you cannot count it, you cannot perform it.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. How long should a Year 8 routine be?
2. What is a highlight?
3. Why write the counts down?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.7

6.7 Performance

Performance is the routine plus the way you enter, face the audience and hold the last shape. Eyes up. A mistake that you continue from is better than a mistake that you narrate with your face.

In a group, the performance is the agreement: same count, same spacing, same energy on the highlight.



A group performance is timing plus spacing. The highlight only works if both are shared.

KEY POINTS

- Enter on purpose.
- Recover from errors without stopping.
- Hold the last shape.
- Applaud other groups as you want to be applauded.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.7

Try this

1. Perform your individual phrase to a small audience.
2. Group performance: one take.
3. Watch another group and name one precise strength.

WATCH OUT

Laughing through your own routine teaches the audience not to take you seriously. Save the laugh for after the hold.

COACH'S TIP

The last shape is the photograph. Give it two full counts.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What should you do when you miss a step?
2. Why hold the last shape?
3. What is a useful comment to another group?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.8

6.8 Cool-down and reflection

Cool down with slower music: march, side stretch, hamstring and hip holds. Bring the pulse down before you sit and talk.

Reflection: which count still wobbles, and who in the group holds the formation together?



Slow music at the end is a physiological tool, not a mood.

KEY POINTS

- Slower music to finish.
- Longer holds than the warm-up.
- Name the wobbly count.
- Thank the group.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.8

Try this

1. Lead a 1-minute cool-down to a quiet track.
2. Circle: one keep, one change, no names of blame.
3. Rewrite the wobbly 8-count only.

WATCH OUT

Skipping the cool-down because you want to watch the film back is still skipping the cool-down.

COACH'S TIP

Fix one 8-count. Do not rebuild the whole routine out of nerves.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. How should the music change in the cool-down?
2. What is a useful team reflection rule?
3. Why rewrite only the wobbly count?

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.9

6.9 Individual assessment

Assessment is a short individual or group performance plus a written plan of counts. Teachers watch timing, control of strength or flexibility elements, spacing and the way you recover from a mistake.

Energy matters. Chaos does not.



Assessment watches control and timing. The extra move you do not quite own can wait.

KEY POINTS

- Timing with the music.
- Controlled elements.
- Spacing and finish.
- A written 8-count plan.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.9

Try this

1. Perform the assessed phrase once, then once more after 30 seconds of quiet.
2. Hand in the written counts.
3. Self-score control from 1 to 4.

WATCH OUT

Adding a new move on assessment day is how controlled work becomes a fall.

COACH'S TIP

Show the routine you own, not the routine you saw last night.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What evidence sits beside the performance?
2. Which qualities are assessed?
3. Why is a second take after 30 seconds useful in rehearsal?

Your year in six sports

Look back across the three terms. The aim was not to become a specialist in one sport. It was to leave Year 8 able to join a game, look after your body and help a teammate.

Unit	One skill I can now explain	One habit I will keep
Volleyball		
Cross Country		
Tennis		
Athletics		
Rugby		
Sports Aerobics		



Six sports, one habit: arrive ready, tell the truth about the last attempt, try the next one.

WRITE THREE SENTENCES

1. The sport in which I improved most, and why.
2. The moment I helped someone else play better.
3. The habit I will take into Year 9.

Keep moving after the last lesson

Physical Education is a school subject. Physical activity is a life habit. The two only meet if you choose them to. You do not need a club trial to stay active. You need a plan you will actually keep.

IN SCHOOL

Join a lunch club. Offer to referee. Help set up the next class.

OUT OF SCHOOL

Walk or cycle a regular route. Play a small-sided game in the park.

WITH OTHERS

Invite someone who does not usually play. Teach them one skill from this book.

ON YOUR OWN

Ten minutes of mobility or an easy run still counts. Write it down.

A FAIR TARGET

Pick one session a week that is not a PE lesson. Put it on a calendar. If you miss it, restart the next week. Do not wait for September.

Looking ahead to Year 9

Year 9 Physical Education asks for more game sense, longer endurance and a clearer coaching voice. The six sports will return in harder forms. The students who enjoy that year are usually the ones who kept the simple habits: a decent warm-up, an honest first contact, and a word for the person next to them.

- Keep a short fitness log over the summer. It does not need to be public.
- Officiate one informal game. The voice is a skill.
- Revisit one weaker-side skill from this book for ten minutes a week.

Word list

These words are used in the units. The definition matches the way the book uses the word.

Attack line	The three-metre line in volleyball that limits back-row attacks.
Deuce	A tennis score of 40-40. The game then continues until one player leads by two points.
Drive phase	The first low, powerful steps of a sprint after the start.
FIG	Federation Internationale de Gymnastique, the international gymnastics federation.
Fix	In rugby, to commit a defender so a teammate becomes free.
Free ball	A gentle volleyball return that lets the receiving team run a full offence.
Overlap	An extra attacker outside the last defender.
Personal best	Your own best legal mark, compared with yourself, not with the year.
Platform	The flat surface made by the forearms in a volleyball pass.
Pop pass	A short rugby pass to a support runner close to the ball carrier.
Rally scoring	A system in which every rally wins a point, not only the serving side.
Sector	The safe marked area in which a throw must land.
Split step	A small hop just as the opponent hits, so you can push off in any direction.
Talk test	A simple check: if you can speak a sentence, the endurance pace is about right.
Touch rugby	A rugby game in which a two-handed touch replaces the tackle.
Turnover	When the other team is given the ball, after six touches or an error.

Sources and references

Facts about rules and governing bodies were checked against the organisations named below. School adaptations (court sizes, time, and the way assessments run at Prime School) follow the department course file that supplied the scope of this book.

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Photographs and still-life plates were prepared for this edition. Diagrams of courts are teaching sketches, not official construction drawings.

PRIME BOOKS

Physical Education

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